

Raconte and Apple Journal

Did we just build Apple's app? No. Here is the difference, in one page.

Where they are the same

Both record on the phone, transcribe on the device with Apple's speech engine, keep the audio, and store copies only in your own iCloud. For someone who wants to talk about today and never touch the text, Apple Journal is free, in the App Store, and end-to-end encrypted without any setting to turn on. On privacy alone, it is at least as good.

What Raconte is for that Journal is not

Reading decades of paper journals aloud and turning them into a searchable, lasting archive. That job needs six things Journal does not have.

1. **The date of the page, not the recording.** A 1998 page read in 2026 is filed under 1998. Dates can be a bare year or month, carry over across a sitting, or be heard spoken at the start of a recording. Journal has one entry date.
2. **Two voices on one page.** A tap while reading marks the switch between print and cursive; the transcript renders the two voices apart and they can be fixed afterwards. Journal has nothing like it.
3. **Corrections that survive re-transcription.** Every edit is a kept revision beside the machine's own version, which stays available to revert to. A later, better pass over the same audio does not erase your work. In Journal the transcript is pasted text.
4. **Text tied to sound.** Each stretch of text remembers which seconds of audio it came from, honestly graded, so a word can one day be tapped to hear it.
5. **An archive you can prove.** Export is plain, documented files with a checksum per file and a verifier that needs no app. Journal exports PDFs and its own file; whether audio is inside is not stated.
6. **Journals as books.** Each paper journal is a named book with a cover, a date span, and an entry count. Journal is one stream.

In one line: Apple Journal is a diary that can record. Raconte is an archival transcription tool that also works as a diary. The recorder is the part they share.

What that means for the therapist conversation

Page 1 of the therapist one-pager makes a privacy case that Journal matches. If she asks "why not Apple's app", the answer is items 3 and 5: your words are never overwritten, and the record can be taken out whole and checked years later. Whether that matters to her clients is her call, and worth asking.